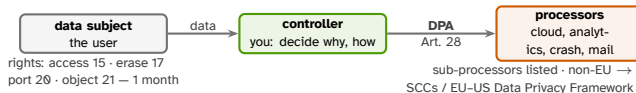


In one line: The law (**GDPR**) says: every purpose needs a **lawful basis**, collect the **minimum**, honour **rights** (access, erasure, portability) and bind every **processor** by contract. The stores enforce the visible parts: **in-app account deletion** (Apple 5.1.1(v), Google Play), **Sign in with Apple token revocation**, honest **privacy labels** / **Data safety**, **ATT** before tracking, stricter rules for **children**. Your SDKs' data is *your* data.

Who is who (GDPR) and which basis



Art. 6 bases — pick one *per purpose*, before collecting:

contract: account, orders, sync — what the user signed up for

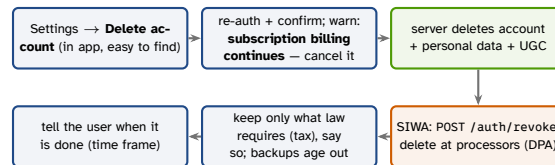
legal obligation: invoices kept for tax

legitimate interests: fraud, security logs (balancing test, opt-out)

consent: marketing push, non-essential analytics, ads, precise location for ads

vital interests · public task — rare in apps. **Art. 9** (health, biometric ID): explicit consent.

“Delete account” — end to end



Rejected: “deactivate” only · “email support” (allowed only for highly regulated apps, 5.1.1(b)) · a link to a generic web page. A web page is fine if the app links *directly* to it. **Google Play:** in-app path **and** a web link (for users who uninstalled).

GDPR in one column

- Art. 5 principles:** lawful/fair/transparent · purpose limitation · **data minimisation** · accuracy · storage limitation · integrity & confidentiality · **accountability** (prove it).
- Consent** (Art. 4(11), 7): freely given, specific, informed, unambiguous, an affirmative act; withdrawing must be as easy as giving; no pre-ticked boxes, no bundling. Record who, when, what text.
- ePrivacy** Art. 5(3): reading/writing on the device (SDK identifiers too) needs consent unless strictly necessary — that, not only GDPR, is why analytics/ads SDKs wait for opt-in in the EU.
- Personal data** includes device IDs, IPs, hashed e-mails (pseudonymised ≠ anonymous) (*unverified*).
- Breach:** tell the authority within **72 h** (Art. 33). **DPIA** (Art. 35) before high-risk processing (large-scale location, health). Privacy by design/default (Art. 25). Fines up to **€20 M or 4%** of worldwide turnover.

Example — revoke Sign in with Apple on deletion

```
POST https://appleid.apple.com/auth/revoke
Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded

client_id=com.example.app
&client_secret=<JWT: ES256, your .p8 key; iss=Team ID,
sub=client_id, aud=https://appleid.apple.com>
&token=<refresh_token stored at sign-in>
&token_type_hint=refresh_token
# 200 = revoked (also if already invalid), empty body.
# client_secret: ES256, exp at most 6 months. Also handle
# the server-to-server events consent-revoked, account-deleted
```

Apple guideline 5.1 — the lines to quote

- 5.1.1(i)** privacy policy linked in App Store Connect *and* in the app; says what, how, retention, how to delete.
- (ii)** consent even for “anonymous” data; paid features can’t depend on it; easy withdrawal.
- (iii)** minimisation: prefer the out-of-process picker or share sheet over full access.
- (v)** “If your app supports account creation, you must also offer account deletion within the app” (since 30 Jun 2022).
- 5.1.2(i)** tracking only with ATT permission; never gate features on it.

ATT is not consent

ATT (iOS 14.5+) is Apple’s gate for **tracking** (linking with other companies’ data) and the IDFA. GDPR/ePrivacy consent is a separate legal duty with its own UI and records — one does not satisfy the other; a user can allow ATT and still refuse analytics.

Labels: Apple vs Google

	App Privacy (Apple)	Data safety (Play)
groups	used to track you · linked to you · not linked per data type: purposes	collected · shared (to third parties)
extra		encryption in transit, deletion requests, independent review
source	your answers + SDKs’; Xcode privacy report aggregates manifests	your answers + SDKs’

Wrong labels are a review/enforcement issue and a regulator’s evidence. Manifests, required-reason APIs, purpose strings, ATT mechanics: see *app-hardening-privacy*.

Children

- COPPA** (US, under 13): verifiable parental consent. 2025 amendments — effective 23 Jun 2025, comply by **22 Apr 2026**: **separate** consent to disclose to third parties (ads), written retention policy, no indefinite retention, security programme.
- GDPR Art. 8**: consent age 16 by default; countries may lower it to 13.
- Apple Kids category** (1.3, 5.1.4): no third-party analytics/ads (narrow exceptions), parental gate. **Declared Age Range** (iOS 26): the user shares an age *range*, not a birthday — for age-assurance laws (US states); Play Age Signals on Android (*unverified*).

Traps

- ! “The analytics SDK collects it, not us” — you are the controller; it is on your label and your DPA.
- ! Deletion that leaves the SIWA link, CRM row, analytics profile and logs behind.
- ! Legitimate interest for ad tracking or a consent screen with only “Accept”.
- ! “We hash e-mails, so it’s anonymous” — still personal data.
- ! Collect “in case we need it later” — breaks purpose limitation and minimisation.

Remember

“A basis per purpose, the minimum, a way out (withdraw, delete) — and every SDK counts as you.”